combine to help you get a broader picture of the performance of the team are:

- ***Estimates*** —The perceived amount of effort that a team gives to a task before they work on it
- ***Volume*** —The number of tasks that are completed
- ***Bugs*** —The number of defects that are created and worked by a team
- ***Recidivism*** —Tasks that someone said were good enough to move forward in the process but ended up getting moved back

As we take a more in-depth look at interpreting this data, you'll see the inconsistencies and ambiguity that result from looking at small bits of all the data you generate in your software development lifecycle.

3.3.1. Task volume

The data we've charted in this chapter so far is the amount of estimated effort completed over time. Measuring estimates is a good place to start because it's already typical practice on agile teams and provides a familiar starting place.

Volume is the number of work items your team is getting done. This is a bit different than measuring estimates, where you're evaluating the amount of estimated effort regardless of the number of tasks you complete. Tracking volume adds a bit more depth to the estimates and bugs because it helps you determine a few key items:

- How big are your tasks?
- What is the ratio of new work to fixing things and revisiting old work?
- Are tasks coming in from outside the intake process?

The delta between estimation and actual time is a valuable metric because it shows you a few potential things:

- How well your team understands the product they're working on
- How well the team understands the requirements
- How well your requirements are written